

10.

The colonial forest policies were driven by the needs of the British Empire with no concern for the well-being of the locals and the environment. Discuss in the context of India. (Answer in 150 words)

औपनिवेशिक वन नीतियां स्थानीय लोगों के कल्याण और पर्यावरण की चिंता किए बिना ब्रिटिश साम्राज्य की जरूरतों से प्रेरित थीं। भारत के संदर्भ में चर्चा कीजिए।

Among many others, Tribals were the biggest stakeholders of forest due to their unique traits which were directly associated with forests. From the oppressive land & revenue policies of British to the Forest Acts of 1865, 1878 & 1927, they were a direct assault on Tribal way of life in some way.

Needs of British Empire -

- 1) Teak from forests as both - locomotive fuel and railway sweepers after 1850s.
- 2) Teak was also needed in shipbuilding to sustain British naval dominance.
- 3) Control shifting cultivation as peasant farming was much easier for British to manage & tax.
- 4) In the late 19th century, the expansion of tea plantations, mining and roads increased the demand of cheap labour for British.

Colonial Forest Policies

- 1) The Forest Acts of 1865, 1878, & 1927

progressively subordinated Tribals to the needs of British Empire.

2) Labour Traps - British authority used to employ large no. of labour from plain areas and restricted their ability to return home even after completion of work. This led to uprisings such as - Khasi uprising.

3) Debt spiral & outsider dominance - The planters used to give loans to Indigo and opium cultivators at a very high interest rate and gave them low wages → creating bonded slave like situation.

The broad aim was to make India a market
of manufactured goods for Britain.
↓
for producing